

```
Retype new UNIX password: (repeat new password for root)
passwd: password updated successfully
```

To disable the root account, use the following `passwd` syntax:

```
sudo passwd -l root
```

You should read more on Sudo by checking out it's man page:

```
man sudo
```

By default, the initial user created by the Ubuntu installer is a member of the group `admin` that is added to the file `/etc/sudoers` as an authorised `sudo` user. If you wish to give any other account full root access through `sudo`, simply add them to the `admin` group.

User profile security

When a new user is created, the `add user` utility creates a brand new home directory named `/home/username`, respectively. The default profile is modelled after the contents found in the directory of `/etc/skel`, which includes all profile basics.

If your server will be home to multiple users, you should pay close attention to the user home directory permissions to ensure confidentiality. By default, user home directories in Ubuntu are created with world read/execute permissions. This means that all users can browse and access the contents of other users home directories. This may not be suitable for your environment.

To verify your current users home directory permissions, use the following syntax:

```
ls -ld /home/username
```

The following output shows that the directory `/home/username` has world readable permissions:

```
drwxr-xr-x  2 username username    4096 2010-06-12
20:03 username
```

You can remove the world readable permissions using the following syntax:

```
sudo chmod 0750 /home/username
```

Some people tend to use the recursive option (`-R`) indiscriminately which modifies all child folders and files, but this is not necessary, and may yield other undesirable results. The parent directory alone is sufficient for preventing unauthorized access to anything below the parent.

A much more efficient approach to the matter would be to modify the `adduser` global default permissions when creating user home folders. Simply edit the file `/etc/adduser.conf` and modify the `DIR_MODE` variable to something appropriate, so that all new home directories will receive the